

Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive content, code, and user experience review of the Royal Sabah Turf Club (RSTC) website located at www.royalsabahturfclub.com.my. The review was conducted on 7 June 2026 and evaluates the site across three critical dimensions: visual aesthetics and UI/UX design, front-end code quality and technical architecture, and content strategy and search engine optimisation. The site was analysed using automated browser tooling, performance profiling, source-code inspection, and visual screenshot comparison at both desktop and mobile viewports.

The RSTC website suffers from significant issues across all evaluated dimensions. The site appears to be built from a legacy Dreamweaver template circa 2015-2018 and has received only incremental updates since. The page load time measured at **4,193 ms** is well above the recommended 3-second threshold, the HTML contains **35 inline style attributes**, **13 of 21 images lack alt text**, and the page has **no meta description** for search engines. The mobile strategy relies on a JavaScript redirect to a separate mobile page, which is an outdated and error-prone approach. These findings indicate that a substantial modernisation effort is required to bring the website up to contemporary professional standards expected of a royal institution.

Key Metric	Current Value	Target Value	Severity
Page Load Time	4,193 ms	< 3,000 ms	High
Meta Description	Missing	Present (150-160 chars)	High
Images Without Alt Text	13 of 21 (62%)	0 (100% coverage)	High
Inline Style Attributes	35 instances	< 5 instances	Medium
Mobile Responsiveness	Separate mobile page (redirect)	Single responsive codebase	High
Total HTTP Resources	51 requests	< 30 requests	Medium
Google AdSense on Official Site	Present	Remove	Medium

Table 1. Key Performance and Quality Metrics Summary

1. Content Review

1.1 Homepage Content Analysis

The homepage content is remarkably sparse for an organisation of this stature. The entire body text consists of just two sentences: "On this beautiful Land Below the Wind sits the Tambalang Racecourse

at Tuaran" and "Watched over by Mount Kinabalu, the Sport of Kings continues to thrive well for over a century since 1908." While these sentences are evocative and culturally resonant, they provide virtually no informational value to a visitor seeking practical details about race schedules, betting procedures, membership, or venue facilities. A homepage for a turf club should serve as the primary gateway to all essential services and information, not merely a poetic tagline.

The welcome section heading reads "WELCOME TO RSTC" which is generic and lacks differentiation. There is no introductory paragraph explaining what RSTC is, no highlight of upcoming race meetings, no call-to-action directing visitors to key services, and no indication of the club's prestige as a royal institution. The absence of a compelling value proposition above the fold means that first-time visitors have little reason to explore further. This represents a missed opportunity to establish authority, trust, and engagement from the moment a user lands on the page.

1.2 Navigation and Information Architecture

The navigation bar contains 10 top-level items: Home, Visit Us, Racing, Race Analysis, Results, Breeding, Apprentice Program, About Us, Photo Gallery, and Commingling. While the categories are generally logical for a turf club website, several issues undermine the navigation's effectiveness. First, the "Commingling" label is a technical betting industry term that most casual visitors will not understand; a label like "International Betting" or "Pari-Mutuel Pooling" would be more accessible. Second, "Apprentice Program" occupies a top-level slot despite having only a single sub-item, inflating the navigation bar unnecessarily. This item would be better placed under "About Us" or "Racing" as a sub-item, freeing horizontal space and reducing cognitive load.

Third, the dropdown menus use paragraph tags (<p>) wrapped around anchor tags, which is semantically incorrect and creates accessibility problems for screen readers. Dropdown content should use proper list structures (/) for correct semantic markup. Fourth, several navigation links point to PDF files directly (e.g., Race Analysis links to SLTC.pdf and PRTC.pdf, Commingling links to three separate PDFs). Opening PDFs without warning disorients users and breaks the browsing flow. These should be converted to proper HTML pages with embedded PDF viewers or clearly marked as downloadable documents with file size indicators.

1.3 Search Engine Optimisation (SEO)

The SEO profile of the RSTC website is critically deficient. The most glaring omission is the complete absence of a meta description tag, which means search engines will auto-generate snippets from page content, typically resulting in unflattering or irrelevant text in search results. There are no Open Graph tags (og:title, og:description, og:image) for social media sharing, meaning any link shared on Facebook, WhatsApp, or Twitter will display without a proper preview card. The page title is simply "Royal Sabah Turf Club" without any descriptive qualifier; a title like "Royal Sabah Turf Club | Horse Racing in Sabah, Malaysia" would be far more effective for both SEO and user recognition.

Additionally, 62% of images on the page (13 out of 21) lack alt text attributes, which hurts both accessibility and image search rankings. The heading structure uses only H2 tags for section titles, with no H1 tag on the page, violating the best practice of having a single descriptive H1 heading per page. The URL structure uses flat file names (index.html, rules.html, etc.) rather than descriptive slugs (e.g., /racing/rules, /visit/tambalang-racecourse), which reduces keyword relevance in search results. Finally, there is no structured data (JSON-LD schema) for the organisation, which would enable rich snippets in Google search results showing the club's address, phone number, and event schedules directly in the search listing.

2. Code Quality Review

2.1 HTML Structure and Semantics

The HTML source code reveals a website built using Adobe Dreamweaver's single-page template, as evidenced by the Adobe Edge Web Fonts script and the template CSS file name "singlePageTemplate.css." This heritage is visible throughout the codebase in the form of excessive inline styles, deprecated HTML practices, and a general lack of semantic markup. The page contains 35 inline style attributes, mixing presentation with content in a way that makes maintenance difficult and violates the separation of concerns principle. Elements like `<br>` tags are used extensively for spacing instead of CSS margins, and the `align="center"` attribute appears multiple times despite being deprecated in HTML5.

The HTML structure itself is poorly organised. The navigation dropdown menus wrap links in tags inside `<div class="dropdown-content">`, when they should use `<ul>/<li>` for semantic correctness. The slideshow section contains a mix of relative and absolute image paths (e.g., "images/gif/uma.jpeg" vs. "/images/gif/2.png?v=2"), and some slides use fully qualified URLs while others use relative paths, indicating inconsistent development practices. The slideshow counter shows "1 / 6" but there are actually 8 slides, revealing a copy-paste error that was never corrected. Multiple sections of code are commented out rather than removed, leaving vestigial markup that adds page weight and confusion.

2.2 CSS and Styling Approach

The website uses a single CSS file (singlePageTemplate.css) supplemented by extensive inline styles throughout the HTML. This approach is characteristic of Dreamweaver-generated websites from the mid-2010s and presents several significant problems. The reliance on inline styles means that any visual change requires editing the HTML itself rather than updating a central stylesheet, dramatically increasing maintenance effort and the risk of inconsistency. The CSS file loads a font from the deprecated Adobe Edge Web Fonts service (use.edgefonts.net), which has been superseded by Adobe Fonts and may face deprecation, creating a future compatibility risk.

The absence of a CSS preprocessor (Sass, Less) or utility framework (Tailwind CSS) means that the stylesheet likely contains significant redundancy and lacks modern features like CSS custom properties, flexbox, and grid layouts. The overlay effect used on the Racing, Apprentice, and Breeding buttons suggests some CSS3 knowledge, but the overall approach is dated. There is no evidence of CSS minification, bundling, or cache-busting beyond the "?v=2" query strings manually appended to some image URLs. A modern CSS architecture would separate layout, components, and utilities into distinct modules and leverage CSS custom properties for theming.

2.3 JavaScript and Interactivity

The JavaScript on the page is minimal and predominantly inline. The carousel/slideshow is implemented with a hand-written script using inline onclick handlers (plusSlides, currentSlide), which is an outdated pattern that mixes behaviour with markup. Modern best practice uses `addEventListener` for separation of concerns and allows for easier debugging and testing. The carousel has no auto-advance functionality, no touch/swipe support for mobile devices, no keyboard accessibility (arrow key navigation), and no CSS transition animations between slides. Each slide simply toggles between `display:none` and `display:block`, resulting in an abrupt, jarring transition that feels unpolished.

The mobile detection script at the top of the page uses `window.innerWidth <= 700` to redirect to a separate mobile page (`index-m.html`), which is a fundamentally flawed approach. This method fails when users resize their desktop browser, when devices have high-DPI screens that report logical widths differently, and when JavaScript is disabled. The redirect also uses an HTTP URL even when the original page is served over HTTPS, creating a mixed content security issue and potential redirect loop. A modern responsive design eliminates the need for separate mobile pages entirely by using CSS media queries and a single codebase that adapts to any viewport size.

2.4 Performance and Loading

The measured page load time of 4,193 ms exceeds the recommended maximum of 3 seconds, with 51 total HTTP resource requests. The page loads multiple third-party scripts that add latency: Google Tag Manager, Google Analytics, Google AdSense (two scripts including the managed ad implementation), Cloudflare Web Analytics, and the Adobe Edge Fonts loader. Each of these represents a network request to an external domain, and the cumulative effect is significant. The inclusion of Google AdSense on an official institutional website is particularly questionable; it introduces privacy concerns, visual clutter, and performance overhead for negligible revenue relative to the club's operating budget.

The aggressive cache-busting meta tags (`<meta http-equiv="Cache-Control" content="no-cache, no-store, must-revalidate">`) force the browser to re-download all assets on every visit, preventing any benefit from browser caching. This is likely a development-era workaround that was never removed before production deployment. Additionally, the HTML5 shim and Respond.js polyfill for Internet Explorer 8 support are still loaded, despite IE8 having negligible market share since 2016. These scripts

add unnecessary weight and should be removed. The favicon uses the full logo image rather than an optimised 16x16 or 32x32 ICO/PNG file, which wastes bandwidth on every page load for an icon displayed at a tiny size.

Issue	Location	Impact	Severity
Inline onclick handlers	Carousel navigation	Accessibility, maintainability	Medium
No meta description	Head section	SEO, search result quality	High
HTTP redirect in mobile detection	Inline script in head	Security (mixed content)	High
35 inline style attributes	Throughout HTML body	Maintainability, consistency	Medium
No-cache meta tags in production	Head section	Performance (repeat visits)	Medium
IE8 polyfills still loaded	Head conditional comments	Unnecessary page weight	Low
Slideshow counter mismatch (1/6 vs 8 slides)	Carousel section	User confusion, unprofessional	Medium
Deprecated Adobe Edge Web Fonts	Head script tag	Future compatibility risk	Medium
Google AdSense on institutional site	Head + injected ad elements	Privacy, performance, credibility	Medium
Full-size logo as favicon	Favicon link tag	Performance, visual quality	Low
Mixed relative/absolute image paths	Carousel slides	Maintainability, potential 404s	Medium

Table 2. Code Quality Issues Inventory

3. UI/UX Design Review

3.1 Visual Design and Aesthetics

The visual design of the RSTC website reflects its Dreamweaver template origins and has not been updated to align with contemporary web design standards. The page lacks a cohesive design system with consistent spacing, typography scale, and colour palette. The carousel images are full-width with no overlay text or calls-to-action, making them large but functionally inert. The transition between slides is an abrupt display toggle with no animation, creating a jarring user experience. The carousel navigation dots are small and lack hover states, reducing discoverability and clickability.

The RaceCard section uses full-width banner images for each card link (RSTC, HKJC, Selangor, Australia/Perth), stacked vertically with `<br>` tags for spacing. This creates a visually monotonous and mobile-unfriendly layout that requires excessive vertical scrolling. On mobile devices, these banners would each occupy the full viewport width, forcing users to scroll past four large images just to reach the content below. A grid-based card layout would be more space-efficient and visually appealing. The three interactive overlay buttons (Racing, Apprentice, Breeding) are a good concept but are executed with dated hover effects and lack visual polish. The social media icons in the footer use image files rather than a modern icon font or SVG sprite, resulting in additional HTTP requests and blurry rendering on high-DPI displays.

3.2 Mobile Experience

The mobile experience is fundamentally compromised by the decision to maintain a separate mobile site (`index-m.html`) rather than implementing a responsive design. This approach was common in the early 2010s but has been superseded by responsive web design for several compelling reasons. First, maintaining two separate codebases doubles the development and maintenance effort while introducing inconsistencies between desktop and mobile content. Second, the JavaScript-based redirect is unreliable; it fails when JavaScript is disabled, when the page is loaded in a non-browser context (e.g., social media crawler), and when users resize their browser window. Third, the redirect sends users to an HTTP URL, creating a security vulnerability and potential SEO issues with duplicate content across different URLs.

Even if the separate mobile site were well-implemented, the 700px breakpoint threshold is arbitrary and does not align with modern device categories. Tablets in portrait mode (768px wide) would receive the desktop site, which is likely too wide for comfortable viewing, while small desktop windows would be incorrectly redirected to the mobile version. A responsive design using CSS media queries with appropriate breakpoints (e.g., 480px for phones, 768px for tablets, 1024px for desktops) would provide a far superior and more reliable experience across all devices with a single codebase.

3.3 Accessibility

The website has significant accessibility deficiencies that would likely fail WCAG 2.1 Level AA compliance. The most critical issue is the 62% of images lacking alt text, which makes the site largely unusable for screen reader users. The carousel has no ARIA labels, no keyboard navigation support, and no pause/play controls, which violates WCAG 2.1 Success Criterion 2.2.2 (Pause, Stop, Hide). The dropdown navigation menus rely on hover states without keyboard-accessible alternatives, making them inaccessible to users who navigate with keyboards or assistive technology. The social media icon links have empty alt attributes (`alt=""`), which hides the link purpose from screen readers, and there are no aria-label attributes to compensate.

The colour contrast of text against backgrounds has not been verified against WCAG AA requirements (minimum 4.5:1 ratio for normal text). The overlay text on the interactive buttons (Racing, Apprentice,

Breeding) appears as white text on semi-transparent dark backgrounds, which may not meet contrast requirements depending on the background image beneath. The page uses `<br>` tags for layout spacing rather than semantic markup, which can confuse screen readers that interpret line breaks as content boundaries. Finally, the focus indicators for keyboard navigation appear to use browser defaults rather than custom, high-visibility focus styles, making it difficult for keyboard users to track their position on the page.

4. Recommendations for Improvement

4.1 Aesthetics and Visual Design

A comprehensive visual redesign should establish a professional design system that reflects the prestige of a royal institution. The colour palette should be rooted in deep greens and golds that evoke the racing tradition and the club's royal patronage, with neutral tones for text and backgrounds. Typography should use a maximum of two typeface families: a serif font for headings (e.g., Playfair Display or Cormorant Garamond) to convey tradition and authority, and a clean sans-serif for body text (e.g., Inter or DM Sans) for readability. All text should use a consistent modular scale (e.g., 1.25 ratio) for font sizes to create visual harmony.

The carousel should be replaced with a modern hero section featuring a high-quality background image or video with overlaid text and a prominent call-to-action button. If a carousel is retained, it should include CSS transition animations (fade or slide), auto-advance with a pause button, touch/swipe support for mobile, keyboard navigation with arrow keys, and ARIA labels for accessibility. The RaceCard links should be redesigned as a responsive card grid (2x2 on desktop, stacked on mobile) with consistent card styling, hover effects, and clear visual hierarchy. The footer should include the club's contact information, physical address, operating hours, and a structured sitemap, not just social media links.

4.2 UI/UX Improvements

The navigation should be restructured to reduce top-level items to 6-7 maximum, consolidating "Apprentice Program" under "About Us" and renaming "Commingling" to a user-friendly label. A hamburger menu should replace the full navigation bar on mobile devices, with smooth slide-in animation and touch-friendly dropdown targets of at least 44x44 pixels. Breadcrumb navigation should be added to interior pages to provide context and improve wayfinding. A persistent "Next Race Day" callout or countdown timer should appear prominently on the homepage, providing immediate value to returning visitors and creating urgency for new visitors.

The separate mobile site should be deprecated in favour of a single responsive codebase using CSS media queries with breakpoints at 480px, 768px, and 1024px. All interactive elements should meet the

44x44 pixel minimum touch target size recommended by Apple and WCAG. Page transitions and loading states should use skeleton screens or progressive loading to reduce perceived latency. A "dark mode" option could enhance the premium feel of the site while improving readability in low-light environments, which is particularly relevant for users checking race results in the evening. Search functionality should be added to help visitors find specific race results, horses, or rules without navigating through multiple menu levels.

4.3 Technical and Efficiency Improvements

The website should be rebuilt on a modern technology stack. The recommended approach is a static site generator (such as Next.js, Astro, or Hugo) that provides server-side rendering for SEO, automatic image optimisation, and built-in performance features. All images should be converted to WebP format with AVIF fallbacks, and responsive image sets should be generated using the srcset attribute to serve appropriately sized images for each viewport. The CSS should be refactored into a utility-first framework (Tailwind CSS) or a well-organised component-based system using CSS custom properties for theming. All inline styles should be eliminated and replaced with proper class-based styling.

The Google AdSense scripts should be removed from this institutional website, as they create privacy concerns, visual clutter, and performance overhead that is inappropriate for a royal club's official web presence. The no-cache meta tags should be replaced with proper cache control headers set at the server level, with versioned or hashed filenames for cache-busting. The IE8 polyfills should be removed immediately. The favicon should be replaced with a properly sized ICO file (16x16 and 32x32). A Content Security Policy header should be added to prevent cross-site scripting attacks, and all resources should be loaded over HTTPS. Finally, critical CSS should be inlined in the <head> and non-critical stylesheets should be loaded asynchronously to eliminate render-blocking resources.

Phase	Timeline	Key Actions	Impact
1. Quick Wins	1-2 weeks	Remove AdSense, add meta description, fix alt text, remove IE8 polyfills, fix carousel counter, remove no-cache tags, optimise favicon	Immediate SEO and performance gains
2. Responsive Overhaul	4-8 weeks	Implement responsive CSS, deprecate mobile redirect, add hamburger nav, redesign card layout, add touch/swipe carousel, keyboard navigation	Mobile usability transformation
3. Visual Redesign	6-10 weeks	New design system, professional typography, hero section, card grid, consistent colour palette, modern carousel, footer enrichment	Professional brand elevation
4. Platform Migration	8-16 weeks	Migrate to Next.js/Astro, implement SSR, image optimisation pipeline, structured data (JSON-LD), Open Graph tags, CSP headers, analytics cleanup	Long-term maintainability and performance

Table 3. Recommended Implementation Roadmap

5. Conclusion

The Royal Sabah Turf Club website requires substantial modernisation to meet the professional standards expected of a royal institution in 2026. The current site suffers from three intertwined problems: a dated visual design rooted in a Dreamweaver template, a technical architecture that relies on outdated practices (separate mobile site, inline styles, IE8 polyfills, no-cache meta tags), and a content strategy that provides minimal informational value to visitors. The combined effect is a website that fails to reflect the prestige and heritage of an organisation that has been operating since 1908.

The good news is that the core content structure and navigation categories are fundamentally sound; the issues lie in execution rather than strategy. A phased approach, starting with the quick wins outlined in Phase 1 (which can be completed in 1-2 weeks with minimal effort), will deliver immediate improvements in SEO and performance while laying the groundwork for the more substantial responsive overhaul and visual redesign in subsequent phases. The ultimate goal should be a modern, responsive, accessible website that honours the club's 118-year heritage while providing the digital experience that visitors, members, and stakeholders expect in the modern era. With a disciplined implementation of the four-phase roadmap, the RSTC website can be transformed from its current state into a professional digital asset worthy of its royal title.